

DESIGN THINKING

IT'S NOT ENOUGH THAT YOU HAVE A SOLUTION.
GET THE BEST ONE

When you hear the word 'design', what's the first thing that pops into your mind? It could be the design of a movie poster you like, the design of your favourite gadgets or if you're thinking bigger – the way your city was planned and designed. It remains a diverse subject since it's the working principle behind why one product seems better than another. In any domain, design plays the role of first draft; the one that is accepted or rejected just on the basis of look & feel or maybe ease of execution. The knowledge of 'design thinking' helps you find problems with the solution. It applies to a 'problem' in any field, more so in the case of innovation. It's not limited to the design of effective projects but also to the general idea of a problem that limits the solution from being more efficient – more efficient in usability and desirability for users and more effective in solving this problem for the thinkers.

WHAT IS DESIGN THINKING?

A problem may have many solutions, albeit only one efficient one. To define the efficiency would mean considering every solution recursively, finding solutions and improving upon the problems until the most efficient solution under the constraints is found. The methodology of design thinking dates back to the ancient Egyptians, who arguably solved a problem that no one understands till date. Design thinking is a solution-oriented problem



Design Thinking leads to product innovation

solving technique that applies to the abstract and thus changes with context. Design itself is the first stage of problem solving and the thought process that goes into the steps involved in finishing this task is broadly known as design thinking. It can also be understood as the design-specific cognitive activities that are undertaken by designers during the process of designing a solution.

According to Tim Brown, CEO and president of IDEO, "Design thinking can be described as a discipline that uses the designer's sensi-

bility and methods to match people's needs with what is technologically feasible and what a viable business strategy can convert into customer value and market opportunity".

The Great War made a mark in world history not only for its death toll but also for being a time of indigenous innovation in communication devices, followed by the Industrial Revolution. The industrial revolution was fueled by the desire to optimise solutions in the cloth loom industry for progress and economic development. The difference was that during the war,